

ACADEMICS



THE CURRICULUM

- The Kindergarten Department uses the Jamaica Early Childhood Curriculum as prescribed by the Early Childhood Commission.
- The Preparatory Department uses the National Standards Curriculum as prescribed by the Ministry of Education.

CONTINUOUS ASSESSMENT

Students are assessed throughout the school year in order to-

- Diagnose pupils' strengths and weaknesses
- Provide feedback on pupils' learning
- Provide a basis for instructional placement
- Inform, guide and communicate learning instruction
- Motivate- focus pupils' attention & effort
- Provide practice in applying knowledge & skills
- Provide a basis for evaluation: I. grading II. promotion III. programme selection/admission

The following are types of assessment that are administered throughout the academic year:

Type of Internal Assessment Administered	Time of Administering	Frequency of Administering
Formative reading Test	Start of School Year	once
Mid Term Tests	Middle of Term	three times
End of Term Examinations	End of Term	three times
Classroom Activities	ongoing	weekly
Homework	ongoing	daily
School or Home-based Projects	ongoing	every six weeks
Summative Reading Test	End of School Year	once

A Progress Report is issued for each term (Christmas; Easter; Summer). The components contribute to each subject as follows-

End of Term Exams	50%
Mid Term Tests	30%
Homework/ Projects	10%
Classroom Activities	10%



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CONTINUOUS ASSESSMENT

Classroom Activities

The ability to demonstrate understanding and apply theoretical concepts to simulated real life scenarios is one of the most important skills that a pupil should hone from classroom activities. Therefore, an active classroom plays a crucial role in measuring learning objectives. It also encourages preparedness and participation as the expectation is established that each pupil must be an active contributor to the learning process. Hence this demonstrative, non-written assessment forms part of the pupil's final grades.

Homework

The school does not wish to infringe upon the rights of children to have sufficient time to participate in home activities, but it must also be recognized by parents and pupils that by the Ministry's curricula, pupils will have homework for the purpose of reinforcing concepts taught in class. Parents/ guardians are expected to offer supervision. Homework should be completed and submitted on the date assigned by the class teacher.

A letter giving good reasons why the work was not done should accompany homework that is not completed or returned on the date assigned. Pupils who fail to complete or submit homework can face sanctions.

School/ Home-based Projects

A project is an in-depth study of a selected topic or theme carried out over a month to six-week period. It is an important strategic technique for the classroom teacher. Projects provide opportunities for pupils to use their initiative to work on problems with the help of people in and around the school community. They allow for an interdisciplinary approach to learning through the integration of materials from a wide range of subject areas. Projects can be individually assigned or group-based.

Rules regarding Projects

- Work should be done by pupils with parent/ teacher supervision.
- Work should be submitted on the date assigned by the teacher.
- Work not submitted on the assigned date will attract a penalty. A letter should accompany all late submissions.
- 5% of the total mark will be subtracted per day for each late assignment. The class teacher **will not** accept work not submitted within a week of the due date.

"Start by doing what's necessary; then do what's possible; and suddenly you are doing the impossible."

-St. Francis of Assisi



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SUBJECT WEIGHTING

Core subjects account for the majority of a pupil's term average. Enrichment subjects make up the remaining 20%. This weighting gives a more accurate indication of the pupil's readiness for national assessments while still maintaining a diverse curriculum.

%	Grades 1-3	%	Grades 4-6
20	Mathematics	20	Mathematics
20	Language Arts	20	Language Arts
20	Integrated Studies	20	Social Studies
20	Mental Ability	20	Science
5	Resource & Technology	5	Mental Ability
5	Creative Arts	5	Resource & Technology
5	Language & Ethics	5	Creative Arts
5	Physical Education	5	Language & Ethics
		-	Physical Education

Enrichment Curriculum			
Term	Resource & Technology	Creative Arts	Language & Ethics
1	Agricultural Science	Drama	HFLE/ Civics
2	Information Technology	Visual Arts	Christian Living
3	Business Basics	Music	Spanish

The enrichment curriculum affords students the opportunity to explore a wide range of areas that adds value to their learning. While these subjects are hands-on and project-based, and gives the students the opportunity to have fun, they are also taught with a goal to integrate core subjects concepts.

GRADING SCHEME

The Academy's scheme mimics that of the Ministry of Education's PEP examinations so that pupils and parents can compare the quality of internal work produced directly with the standards required to excel in external exams.

Score		GRADES 1-3		GRADES 4-6
90-100%	A	Highly Proficient	A+	Highly Proficient
80-89%	B	Proficient	A	High Proficiency
70-79%	C+	Developing	B	Proficient
60-69%	C	Beginner	C	Developing
50-59%	C-	Beginner	C-	Beginner
0-49%	F	Beginner	F	Beginner





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PRIZEGIVING

At the annual Prizegiving exercise pupils are recognized for their excellent academic achievements and outstanding contributions in community activities. Suffice to say, although the emphasis is on academics as the most important aspect of school life, other categories are recognized to encourage participation in school life. Other areas of recognition include sports, the arts, citizenship, compliance to school rules and school spirit.

HONOUR ROLL

The Honour Roll serves to recognize academic excellence among pupils. Pupils are encouraged to be disciplined and consistent in their work output so that they can realize their full potential. Those who achieve at least an “A” average across all terms within an academic year are enlisted on the Honour Roll. These students are specially recognized at the Prizegiving exercise the following academic year.

PRINCIPAL’S LIST

Like the Honour Roll, the Principal’s List recognizes students who have achieved at least an “A” average, but for each term. Students are recognized through the “Excellence” noticeboard publication of their names along with the photographs of the top three performers in each grade.

BRIGHT SPARKS

This reward programme caters to advanced pupils at the Upper School. It encourages said pupils to aim for and maintain a straight “High Proficiency” (HP) grade in all their PEP sittings. Pupils are first enrolled in Grade 5, once the PEP 4 results are published. They are given additional attention where it is needed to maximize their performance for the next PEP sitting. Pupils continue in the programme at Grade 6 if they gain straight HP in PEP 5 as well. Their advanced tutoring continues for their PEP 6 sittings. If a student gains straight HP in PEP 6 they will be specially rewarded and recognized at their Graduation exercise.



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MINISTRY OF EDUCATION ASSESSMENTS

All pupils are required to sit Ministry-based assessments at the designated age or grade level. To protect the integrity of these national exams and the ability of the school to administer them correctly, parents should ensure that pupils adhere to the rules governing their sitting. For example, pupils must be punctual, fully equip and attire in the school's full uniform for all assessments. Variations in this dress code, including incorrect uniform implements or PE gears will not be accommodated by the school.

ABOUT THE PEP EXAMS

It is important that pupils and parents understand that every stage of these exams matter. Final scores and placements are based on the pupils accumulative scores (**Grade Four- 10%; Grade Five- 15%; Grade Six- 75%**). While this is so, the majority of the scores are gained at Grade Six over three months of examinations.

(Disclaimer: Exams are subject to Ministry of Education adjustments)

YEAR	EXTERNAL ASSESSMENTS	TIME
K2	Age Four Assessment	June
1	Grade One Individual Learning Profile	Sept.
2	Grade Two Diagnostic Test	May
3	Grade Three Diagnostic Test	May
4	- Literacy test and Language Arts Performance Task Test - Numeracy Test and Mathematics Performance task Test	June
5	- Language Arts Performance Task - Science Performance task - Mathematics Performance Task - Social Studies Performing Arts	June
6	Ability Test	March
	- Language Arts Performance Task - Mathematics Performance Task	March
	- Language Arts Curriculum-based Test - Mathematics Curriculum-based Test - Social Studies Curriculum-based Test - Science Curriculum-based Test	April

"If you have no confidence in self, you are twice defeated in the race of life."

-Marcus Garvey

